GAOTINGWE PHALATSE

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Economic Analyst & Market Researcher with a BCom Honours in Transport Economics and 4 years of experience in regulated environments (Public Finance & Industrial Procurement).

Unlike a theoretical economist, I possess practical experience in analysing market structures, supply chain dynamics, and regulatory compliance (PFMA & BBBEE). My background in Transport Economics provides specific expertise in assessing barriers to entry (logistics/freight) and market concentration—critical factors in Merger Analysis. I am eager to apply my investigative research skills to the Competition Commission's Mergers & Acquisitions Division to ensure fair market practices.

EXPERIENCE

DECEMBER 2023 TO NOVEMBER 2025

GRADUATE TRAINEE BUYER

PROCUREMENT & FINANCE

AFRIMAT INDUSTRIES (PTY) LTD, LICHTENBURG PLANT, NORTH WEST

- **Market Investigation**: Conducted "Request for Quote" (RFQ) processes which function as micro-market investigations—analysing supplier concentration, pricing power, and availability.
- **Investigative Due Diligence**: Performed rigorous checks on new market entrants (vendors) to verify capacity and compliance, ensuring no fraudulent or anti-competitive behaviour.
- **Price Analysis**: Analysed input costs versus market trends to determine if supplier price increases were justified or a result of market dominance.
- **Regulatory Compliance**: Enforced strict adherence to company procurement policies and BBBEE regulations, mirroring the Commission's need for regulatory oversight.

MAY 2021 – APRIL 2023

BUDGET ANALYST INTERN

PUBLIC FIANACE & DATA MANAGEMENT

NORTH WEST PROVINCIAL TREASURY, MMABATHO, NORTH WEST

- **Regulatory Reporting**: Compiled high-level expenditure reports for oversight bodies, ensuring alignment with the PFMA and Treasury Regulations.
- **Variance Analysis**: Investigated deviations in departmental spending, identifying root causes and recommending corrective actions.
- **Data Management**: Managed complex datasets to track fund utilization, ensuring transparency and accountability in public funds.

JULY 2016 – JANUARY 2018

STORE ASSISTANT

STUDENT ACADEMIC LIFE CYCLE ADMINISTRATION

NORTH WEST UNIVERSITY, MAHIKENG, NORTH WEST

- Inventory Control: Managed receiving, storage, and issuance of stock.
  Transferable Skill: Managing equipment and file storage for research projects.

EDUCATION

2024

BACHELOR OF COMMERCE HONOURS, TRANSPORT ECONOMICS, NORTH WEST UNIVERSITY

- Dissertation: "Emerging Transportation Technologies – Their Impact on The Environment and Sustainable Mobility in South Africa."
- Key Performance: Achieved 73% for Dissertation; 82% for Transport Policy & Regulation.
- Relevance to Competition Law: Deep understanding of industrial organisation, transport costs as barriers to entry, and market regulation.

2018 - 2020

BACHELOR OF COMMERCE, ECONOMICS, NORTH WEST UNIVERSITY

- Distinctions: Operations Management (76%), Public Finance & Policy Analysis (75%), Macro-Economics (76%).
- Relevance: Strong quantitative background for data analysis and strong foundation in micro-economic theory & market structures.

2011 - 2015

BACHELOR OF COMMERCE, TRANSPORT ECONOMICS, NORTH WEST UNIVERSITY

- Distinctions: Project Management (77%), Inferential Statistics & Operations Research (78%)

SKILLS

- ***Data Analysis***: Quantitative Analysis, Variance Analysis, Forecasting (Excel), Root Cause Identification
- ***Regulatory Framework***: PFMA
- **Supply Chain Logic**: Inventory Management Principles, Logistics Coordination, Strategic Sourcing, Resource Coordination
- **Reporting**: Academic Writing, Presentation Preparation
- ***Technical Proficiency***: Advanced MS Excel, Google Workspace, SAP (Procurement Modules), Budget Forecasting Systems
- ***Language***: English, Tswana & Pedi
- ***Communication***: Strategic Reporting, Clear Verbal & Written Communication, Cross-Functional Collaboration
- ***Economic Logic***: Market structures, Micro-Economics

REFERENCES

- Boitumelo Mosiane, Senior Buyer
  Afrimat Industries SA, Lichtenburg Plant
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  071 376 1006 & 018 492 0698
- Vusi Radebe, Warehouse Supervisor
  Afrimat Industries SA, Lichtenburg Plant
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  083 966 9520 & 018 492 0792
- Keletso Tshekoeng, Deputy Director
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